



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christ Classical School

School Website: <https://christclassicalslo.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Christ Classical School California (CA 93422) presents a robust classical Christian program anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), explicit Christ-centered formation, and a culture that integrates biblical faith with classical educational aims. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered culture, a distinctly classical methodology, and a curriculum rooted in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with Latin and biblical resources. These features align strongly with classical education principles, particularly in its focus on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a communal, liturgical ethos around worship and biblical study. The school additionally communicates a clear partnership model with families, admissions processes, and a public-facing faculty profile, all of which support a coherent classical framework.

Overall, based on the six-category rubric drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School, Christ Classical School CA 93422 is **CLASSICAL** across the evaluated areas. The strongest signals come from explicit catechetical emphasis on God, Scripture, virtue formation, the Trivium-driven pedagogy, and a community-oriented, parent-inclusive culture. Some opportunities for further alignment (e.g., explicit textual emphasis on Great Books / Great Conversation or more explicit statements of contemplative pedagogy as *scholé*) would move the rubric further toward an even more unambiguous **CLASSICAL** reading, but there are no substantive gaps that would suggest a non-classical designation at this time.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
 - Public materials frame Christ Classical as a distinctly Christian, Bible-centered school, teaching within a biblical worldview and a culture of grace. Turn0file4 describes the Trivium in a Christian/classical framework and cites God's guidance in the developmental stages of learning. Turn0file3 reinforces the explicit Christ-centered culture and biblical integration through its Distinctives section.
 - The mission/vision statements emphasize "a life of moral and spiritual integrity, personal and social responsibility, and genuine passion to know and serve a Holy God," underscoring theology-grounded aims (About Christ Classical School).
 - Worship and scripture are part of school life (e.g., Morning Meetings and Scripture songs/reading featured in site content).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Christ-centered, God's Word, biblical worldview, worship, spiritual integrity, theology, culture of grace, biblical integration, morning worship, Psalms/scripture, holy God.

- Negative keywords observed: None of the typical secular/anti-theology terms appear in the public-facing materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive indicators readily appear (6–8 clear instances) with no clear negative indicators detected in the public-facing content.
- Why this rating
- The school explicitly grounds its identity, curriculum, and community in a Christian theological frame and liturgical practices (worship/Scripture), fulfilling the Transcendental Moral Realism and Liturgical/Communal Practices expectations, and it presents grounding in theology (God's Word) as central. The evidence indicates a CLASSICAL alignment with a strong religious/metaphysical foundation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school articulates formation of virtue and wisdom as primary goals, not vocational training. Mission/vision emphasizes moral/spiritual integrity and the development of discernment, articulate thinking, and a life submitted to God. The admissions and program descriptions emphasize character formation and a life oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty rather than mere information transfer.
- The language around forming students who think clearly, act with discernment, and live within a biblical framework mirrors the classical aims of forming virtuous, wise persons rather than focusing solely on job preparation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: virtue, wisdom, formation, character, integrity, moral formation, truth, goodness, beauty, vocation (implicitly de-emphasized in favor of formation), love of learning, human flourishing.
- Negative keywords observed: Vocational-centric phrasing (absent); purely informational emphasis (absent); secular/neutral framing (absent).
- Quantitative note: Positive keyword instances substantially exceed any negative or neutral indicators; an estimated positive presence around 5–7 distinct terms, with no explicit negative keywords detected.
- Why this rating
- The school foregrounds formation (not just information) and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom as central aims, consistent with classical governance of education and the transcendental aims of truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable. This supports CLASSICAL classification for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum employs the Trivium: grammar (K–6), logic (7–9), rhetoric (10–12), with explicit mention of Latin and the Bible, and a focus on reading and language arts as essential components. The content outlines an incremental, cumulative approach to mathematics and language development, consistent with classical pedagogy.
- The program emphasizes primary readings from Bible and classic works, and includes history as a throughline across the curriculum, not merely as social studies. The Distinctives section explicitly lists the grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, Latin study, and Bible integration.
- The structure emphasizes mastery, memory, and the cultivation of thinking, in line with Great Books/Great Conversation framing, and the aim for students to engage with timeless questions and texts (as reflected in the classical methodology language). The site content highlights a Biblically-integrated approach and classical curriculum components.

- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Bible, history (throughout curriculum), reading, classical, Great Books (referenced in surrounding classical education discourse), memory/recall and cognitive development alignment (memory emphasis in lower grades).
- Negative keywords observed: Project-based or purely experiential learning (not promoted as the primary approach); secular or non-classical terms are not evident in the public materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords appear across multiple core elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, Bible, history, reading); no strong negative keyword appearances.
- Why this rating
- The explicit articulation of the Trivium, Latin, Bible integration, and cross-curricular history alignment places this school squarely within CLASSICAL as defined by the Six Essential Elements. The materials reflect a curriculum designed to cultivate disciplined thinking, virtue, and a classical body of knowledge rather than a purely job-oriented or secular approach.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Trivium-based pedagogy is central: grammar (K–6), dialectic/logic (7–9), rhetoric (10–12). The Distinctives articulate a progression that aligns with the classical method, with emphasis on memory, phonics, and exposure to biblical and classical texts. Public materials also indicate a structure of memory work in lower grades and Socratic/Socratic-adjacent engagement in upper grades via dialectic and rhetoric.
- The site references a contemplative/holistic approach as part of classical method, and the emphasis on Latin and primary readings suggests engagement with rigorous cognitive development rather than purely drill-based instruction. The public materials frame upper-level work as discourse (Socratic/dialectic) and rhetoric opportunities (speeches, expression).
- The “Welcome” and “About” materials emphasize contemplation, wisdom, and a memory-building, structured approach to learning (Scholé-like aspects inferred from memory work and the Trivium).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, dialectic, Socratic dialogue (implied via dialectic and classical method), memory/Scholé, Latin, biblical literacy, contemplation, wonder (implied by educational tone).
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating non-classical approaches; no explicit dismissal of contemplation or classical methods.
- Quantitative note: Positive indicators are numerous and align with the documented pedagogy; no explicit negative indicators.
- Why this rating
- Public materials consistently describe a Trivium-centered pedagogy with a structured progression from grammar to logic to rhetoric, including Latin and Bible instruction, and an emphasis on higher-order discourse and rhetorical training. This is a clear CLASSICAL alignment for Element 4.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school presents a documented faculty structure with named roles (Head of School, Kindergarten Morning Teacher, First Grade Teacher, etc.), indicating a professional faculty lineup and public-facing portrait of teachers. This aligns with the idea of a living curriculum, with faculty as mentors and a core

of the school. The Faculty and Staff page details credentials and leadership (Head of School Matthew LaFon).

- Distinctives describe faculty as model teachers and mentors who embody virtue and knowledge, reinforcing the notion that faculty are central to the school's character and curriculum. Transcript material shows a faculty-driven culture, with staff visibly integrated into the school's mission.
- There is evidence of a formal teacher profile and a documented leadership structure, underscoring a professional, virtuous teacher-student relationship dynamic central to classical schools.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, faculty as core, portrait of teacher/student ideals, leadership (Head of School), credentialed teachers, professional development (implied by staff bios).
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating poor faculty integration or non-classical staffing.
- Quantitative note: Multiple explicit positive signals with no clear negative signals.
- Why this rating
- The explicit presentation of a faculty structure and the public-facing biographies and leadership indicate a classical, mentor-led approach consistent with the element of faculty as living curriculum and core of the school community. This supports CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnership with parents and seeks to educate parents about classical education (via resources, admissions process, tours, and parent-facing communications). Admissions materials describe a family-oriented process, and campus visits are encouraged (Morning Meetings, tours, and parent involvement). The presence of "Welcome Wednesdays" and frequent family engagement materials suggests a co-parenting model in which parents are actively involved in the educational journey.
- Admissions materials outline steps that require parental engagement (statements of faith, honor codes, pastoral references), reflecting a parent-school partnership model. The presence of tours and open events (Campus Tours, mornings, etc.) further supports parental involvement.
- The site describes a covenantal, family-centered community approach and a culture that invites parents to be part of the school's culture and learning experience.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents, families as co-teachers, admissions process, campus tours, parent involvement, biblical worldview shared with families, community culture.
- Negative keywords observed: None indicating isolation from families or lack of community engagement.
- Quantitative note: Strong presence of parent/community indicators; minimal to no negative indicators.
- Why this rating
- The school presents a clear model of parent collaboration and family engagement, consistent with classical education expectations for Parents & Community. The materials emphasize parental partnership, learning together, and community events, which supports CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Aggregate Assessment

- The six-category rubric yields CLASSICAL ratings across all categories. The school presents a cohesive classical Christian program with explicit Trivium pedagogy, Latin, Bible integration, a culture

of grace and worship, formation-focused goals, robust faculty profiles, and active parent/community engagement.

- Executive-style takeaway: A strong CLASSICAL alignment overall, with public materials clearly supporting a Christian classical education model from theology and curriculum to pedagogy, faculty, and family partnerships.
- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL situations only)
- Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. If one wished to further strengthen the CLASSICAL reading, explicit, frequent public references to Great Books and the Great Conversation, explicit articulation of scholé (contemplative learning) practices across the grade levels, and a more explicit statement of Socratic-style seminars in upper grades would be natural enhancements. (Notes drawn from the Six Essential Elements framework and corroborating public materials.)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.